

Social Studies 30-1 – Examples for Position Paper Paragraphs (Political)

Potential Quotes

-  Democracy is the worst form of government, except for all those others that have been tried from time to time.
-  Rights and freedoms are essential to a democracy; however, there may be times when a temporary suspension of rights and freedoms is necessary to guarantee the preservation of democracy.
-  It is the responsibility of individuals to hold the government accountable for its policies and actions. A government that does not reflect the will of the people must be removed from power.

Thesis

Nations should embrace the democratic perspective of the source as it ensures accountability and limits the power of the government.

Paragraph #1 - Example Paragraph (this could be more than 1 paragraph kiddies)

T: When nations do embrace the views and ideas of the quote it will lead to the preservation of rights and freedoms. (The most viable political system, is reflective of the will of the people. Embracing the source will create accountability and responsible government. Embracing the source will create a system of checks and balances to prevent too much government control.)

E: Representative Government/Parliamentary Government/discuss our MP and his role
Lobby Groups
Charter of Rights and Freedoms, 1982
Periodic Elections
Opposition Parties
Free Press (watchdog)
Separation of Powers: Montesquieu
Right to Dissent: Voltaire
Freedom of Religion and Expression: Locke
Direct Democracy (referendums): Quebec in 1995

C: The closing sentence should mirror your topic sentence.

Paragraph #2 - Non - Example Paragraph (Could also be more than 1 paragraph)

T: When nations do not embrace the views and ideas of the quote it will lead to a lack of rights and freedoms (exploitation of the people). There is a lack of accountability with such political systems. This is seen in totalitarian states, oligarchies, tyranny of the majority, etc...

E: Enabling Act of 1933: Hitler

Night of Long Knives: Hitler

Persecution of Minorities - Nuremburg Decrees and Night of Broken Glass, Final Solution: Hitler

The Great Purges, De-Kulakization, and Gulags: Stalin

Politburo in the Former USSR: Stalin

Tiananmen Square, China in 1989

One-Party Techniques: Scapegoating, Fear and Terror, Controlled press, Propaganda, Machiavellianism

***Edmund Burke: Classical conservatism: Only a select few. Limited electorate.

C: The closing sentence should mirror your topic sentence.

Paragraph #3 - Condition Paragraph #1

T: Although nations should embrace the democratic perspective of the source, there may be times when a temporary suspension of rights and freedoms is necessary to guarantee the preservation of democracy. (Government may have to limit civil liberties of extreme groups or movements)

E: Japanese Internment Camps during World War II

USA PATRIOT Act (USA)

War Measures Act during FLQ Crisis of 1970

No-Fly Lists and Body Scanners at Airports

Martial Law: Suspension of liberties such as a curfew

Sunset Clause

Emergencies Act of 1988 (replaced the War Measures Act)

Restricting Freedom of Movement during SARS Outbreak

Martial Law during Unlawful Protests: France 2005

C: The closing sentence should mirror your topic sentence.

Paragraph #4 - Condition Paragraph #2

T: Nations should embrace the democratic perspective of the source, they should never suspend rights and freedoms as it will create an illiberal nation.

E: Japanese Internment Camps during World War II
USA PATRIOT Act (USA)
War Measures Act during FLQ Crisis of 1970
No-Fly Lists
Body Scanners at Airports
Emergencies Act of 1988
Restricting Freedom of Movement during SARS Outbreak
Martial Law during Unlawful Protests: France 2005
WMA is no longer around as it violates your civil liberties

C: The closing sentence should mirror your topic sentence.

Paragraph #5- Condition Paragraph #3

T: Although the principles of liberal democracies create the most viable political system, there are weaknesses and disadvantages of democracy. At times, will of the people may not be reflected. Regardless, it is still the most effective method of governing.

E: Voter apathy
Minority governments are unstable- parties form coalitions. Votes of non-confidence
Disadvantages of proportional representation
Lobby groups can become too influential
1st-past-the-post may not reflect the will of the people (Green Party results 2008)
Senators in the Canadian Leg. Branch are appointed, not elected.
Party discipline: MP's are more accountable to their party than to their constituents

C: The closing sentence should mirror your topic sentence.